NIKHIL L

Executive Program Manager · Aerospace & Defense · Customer & Supplier Strategy
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$10M+ Program Portfolio | **130%** Revenue Growth | **100%** On-Time Delivery | **7** Global OEM Customers

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Executive Program Manager with 3+ years of dedicated programme management experience leading complex aerospace and defence programmes from NPI through full-rate production. Proven record managing a **$10M+ programme portfolio** across Boeing, GE Aviation, Dassault, Collins Aerospace, and IAI — delivering **130% revenue growth** and **100% on-time delivery**. Deep expertise in AS9100 quality systems, supply chain optimisation, risk mitigation, contract management, and cross-functional leadership across global teams in India, France, Israel, Germany, and the US.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Program Lifecycle Management · New Product Introduction (NPI/NPD) · APQP · AS9100 Compliance · Risk Mitigation & Compliance · Stakeholder Management · Cross-functional Team Leadership · Supply Chain Management · Supplier Negotiation & Vendor Management · Budgeting & P&L Monitoring · Contract Review · Change Management · KPI & Milestone Tracking · Earned Value Management (EVM) · Program Management Reviews (PMR) · OEM Relationship Management · Value Stream Mapping (VSM) · SAP ECC & S4 HANA

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Executive Program Manager
Oct 2025 – Present

Tata Advanced Systems Limited (TASL) · Bengaluru, India

- Own the **Boeing 787 composites programme** end-to-end — driving production part rate ramp-up to meet OEM delivery schedules and revenue targets.
- Lead contract and price negotiations with global OEMs, securing commercially favourable terms while reinforcing long-term strategic partnerships.
- Deliver business case analyses and financial models to support executive gate reviews and programme investment decisions.
- Conduct comprehensive contract reviews ensuring AS9100 compliance, identifying programme risks, and uncovering value creation opportunities.
- Reduced production cycle time through structured workflow redesign and measurable process efficiency improvements.
- Coordinate cross-functional teams — Engineering, SCM, Quality, Finance — to align execution with contractual milestones and customer expectations.
- Serve as executive point of contact for OEM customer relationship management, aligning programme objectives with client requirements.
- Monitor programme P&L against business case baselines; present risks, milestones, and delivery KPIs at PMRs and board-level reviews.

Associate Program Manager
Jul 2023 – Oct 2025

Rangsons Aerospace Pvt Ltd · Mysore, India

- Led aviation tube and structural assembly programmes for global OEMs: **GE Aviation, IAI, Elbit Systems, Moog Controls, Collins Aerospace, Siemens, and Dassault Aviation**.
- Managed a **USD 6M+ programme portfolio**, delivering **130% sales growth** and USD 2M incremental revenue through strategic RFQs and NPI execution.
- Directed supplier strategy and SCM initiatives — cutting supply chain costs by **14%**, raw material costs by **12%**, with **95%+ on-time delivery** sustained.
- Spearheaded NPD/NPI from concept validation through APQP and production ramp-up, ensuring on-time, successful programme launches.
- Boosted operational efficiency by **15%** and compressed development cycles by **30%** through structured change management and process optimisation.
- Achieved **100% on-time delivery** and eliminated **71% of project bottlenecks** via cross-functional collaboration and proactive risk management.

- Managed risk across **10+ projects** over programme tenure, cutting cost overruns by **20%** through early identification and structured mitigation planning.
- Evaluated feasibility and prepared cost projections for **20 RFQs**, aligning programme objectives with market requirements and business targets.
- Coordinated international delivery teams across France, Israel, Germany, and the US — ensuring aerospace standards compliance and seamless execution.
- Presented strategic insights, programme updates, and KPI dashboards at board-level Management Review Meetings (MRM).
- Led the **Dassault Aviation customer audit**, successfully achieving **Rangsons approval for 72 DGQT processes**, reinforcing supplier qualification standards and strengthening the Dassault partnership.

Service Desk Engineer *Oct 2022 – Apr 2023*

DXC Technologies India Pvt Ltd · Bengaluru, India

- Delivered global IT support to Honeywell enterprise users, enhancing system uptime and end-user experience.
- Reduced ticket resolution time by **20%** through streamlined troubleshooting workflows and process improvements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Revenue Growth:** Scaled programme revenue 130% within 6 months (USD 156K → USD 365K) through strategic RFQs and NPI execution.
- **Inaugural Leadership:** Established foundational PM processes as the first Programme Manager for structural assembly at Rangsons Aerospace.
- **Lead Time Reduction:** Implemented Value Stream Mapping (VSM) for the Elbit Systems programme, cutting lead time by 50%.
- **Cost Optimisation:** Reduced special process costs by 20% and raw material costs by 12% through supplier strategy and negotiation.
- **Delivery Excellence:** Sustained 100% on-time delivery across all key OEM programmes.
- **Bottleneck Elimination:** Removed 71% of project bottlenecks through cross-functional process re-engineering.

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Microsoft Project · Microsoft Excel (Advanced) · Power BI · SAP ECC & S4 HANA (ERP) · Digital Twin Collaboration · Perplexity AI

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Project Management Foundations — Microsoft & LinkedIn Learning
- Risk Management — Project Management Institute (PMI)
- Supply Chain Foundations — Project Management Institute (PMI)
- Six Sigma White Belt & Lean Six Sigma White Belt — Council of Six Sigma Certification (NY)
- EF Standard English Test — EF SET Certificate 77/100 (C2 Proficient)

EDUCATION

B.E. in Mechanical Engineering *2018 – 2022 · CGPA 7.6*

Maharaja Institute of Technology Thandavapura · Mysore, India

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · Kannada (Native / Bilingual) · Hindi (Proficient)